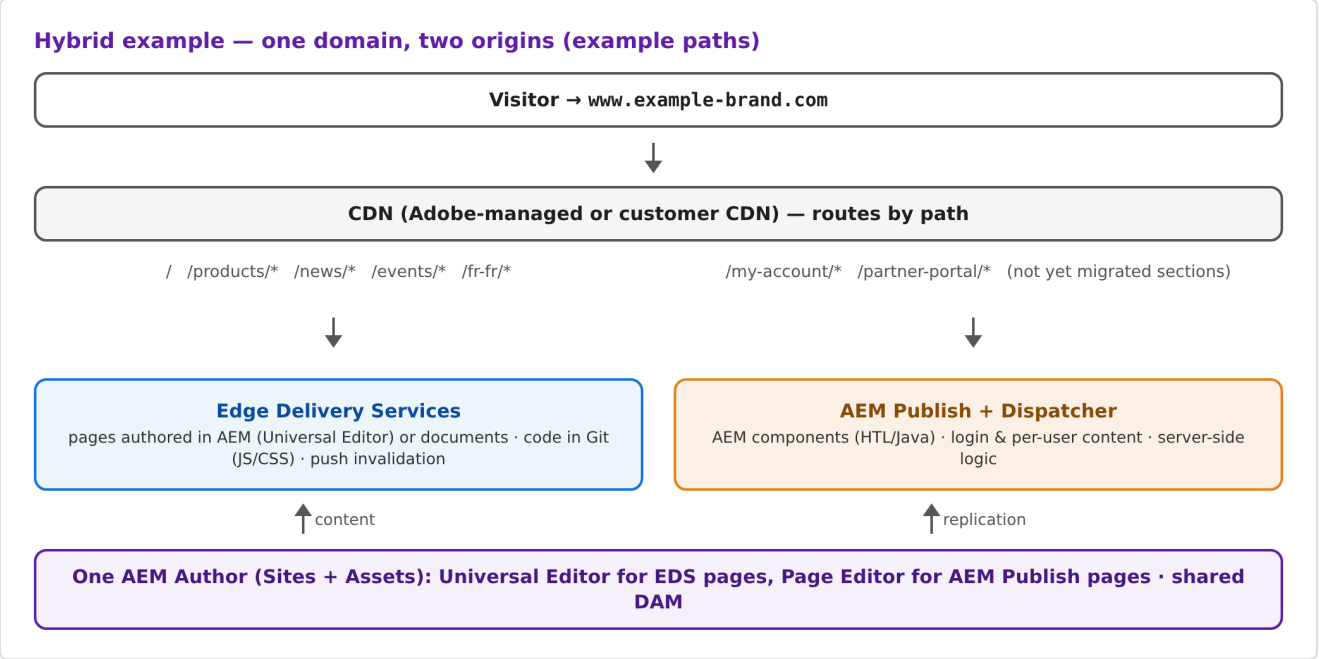
Where and when to use AEM vs Edge Delivery Services

AEM is the content platform. Edge Delivery Services (EDS) is the way the website is delivered. It is not *AEM or EDS*: authors keep working in **AEM Author** (Sites, Assets, workflows, translation, multi-site management). The decision is **how each site — or each part of a site — is delivered to visitors**.

Edge Delivery Services — default for the public website	**Classic AEM Publish — only where needed**	**AEM Headless — for apps & channels**
Public content that is **the same for every visitor**: brand and marketing sites, country / language sites, product and solution pages, news, articles, insights, press releases, events, webinars, campaigns, landing pages	**Login with per-user content or permissions** (customer / partner portals, *my account*, gated content per user group)	Content that feeds a **mobile app, kiosk, partner feed** or other channels — not only the website
Why: fastest pages and best SEO (built for a Lighthouse score of 100), changes live in minutes without release pipelines, no AEM Publish servers to run, same AEM authoring with the visual Universal Editor	**Heavy server-side business logic** on every request	The **same structured content** reused across website and apps
	AEM features EDS does not offer (e.g. **ContextHub targeting, Timewarp**)	
	Existing complex AEM sections not worth rebuilding yet	

Recommendation — hybrid, moving step by step

1. **New and public content sites go on Edge Delivery Services** from day one.
2. **Login, portal and logic-heavy sections stay on AEM Publish.**
3. **One domain, one AEM Author, one DAM** — the CDN sends each URL path to the right place.
4. **Move the remaining sections** to EDS as their requirements fit.



Adobe confirms this setup: *"Edge Delivery, AEM Sites and AEM Assets can co-exist on the same domain. This is a common use case for larger websites."*

> **In one line:** use **Edge Delivery Services** for everything public and content-driven, keep **AEM Publish** only where you need personalised logged-in experiences or server-side logic — and manage all of it from the **same AEM**.

Source: Adobe Experience League — AEM as a Cloud Service Architecture: https://experienceleague.adobe.com/en/docs/experience-manager-cloud-service/content/overview/architecture